

Charter School Jobs® — Employer Conversion Strategy

Site Audit, Customer Journey & Annual Integrated Marketing Plan

1. Current State Audit (as of July 2026)

I reviewed the live site as a prospective employer customer would encounter it: Home → Post Jobs → Annual Posting Plans → Buy Credits, plus the live event page (NYC fair) and About Us.

What's working

- **The core offer is genuinely good.** Annual plans undercut à la carte pricing dramatically — Platinum drops cost-per-posting to \$1.66 vs. Bronze's \$13.31, and every plan bundles a career fair table discount (5–20%). That discount is a strong, underused lever.
- **20+ years of trust signals exist** (the "7,500+ certified teachers placed since 2003" stat on the event page, the massive customer logo list on the homepage) but they're scattered, not concentrated where a buyer is deciding.
- **The event page (nyc-fair) is well-built** — it already does dual-audience segmentation (For Teachers / For Schools) with a clean value-prop grid. This is your best template for employer-facing copy elsewhere on the site.

What's costing you conversions

1. **The homepage speaks to candidates, not buyers.** "WANTED: Excellence and Results" and the three-bullet role list is 100% candidate-facing copy sitting above the fold on the page every employer lands on first. The only employer CTA ("Post Jobs") is visually equal to "Find a Job" — no hierarchy favors your paying customer.
2. **The customer logo wall is buried and unstyled.** ~130 school names in a flat list, alphabetized, no logos, no filtering, no "these are CMOs managing 20+ schools" framing. This is your single best trust asset and it currently reads like a footer sitemap, not social proof.
3. **No cost comparison exists anywhere in the funnel.** A first-time buyer sees Bronze at \$800/yr with no anchor. They have to do the per-posting math themselves. Nobody does that math — you should do it for them, prominently, next to the à la carte credit page.
4. **The annual plans page sells slots, not outcomes.** "5 job posting credits per Month" is a feature. It doesn't say what that unlocks (e.g., "post every open role, all year, without re-budgeting mid-year").

5. **Career fairs and posting plans don't talk to each other.** The nyc-fair event page — despite being your strongest page — never mentions the annual plan discount. "Register Your School" leads straight to a one-off event purchase with zero mention that plan holders save up to 20%. Conversely, the Annual Plans page mentions the fair discount in one line of body copy and then never shows it again in the pricing cards themselves.
 6. **No urgency or seasonality.** Charter school hiring is seasonal (heaviest Feb–Aug for the following school year). Nothing on the site reflects that a school evaluating in October has different needs than one evaluating in March.
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2. Employer Customer Journey (current vs. target)

Stage	Current Experience	Target Experience
Awareness	Referral, Google search, or a career fair invite email	Same, but landing pages are role-specific (HR Director vs. CMO Recruiting Lead)
Arrival	Lands on candidate-oriented homepage	Lands on homepage with an employer-first hero above the fold, logo wall as immediate proof
Consideration	Clicks "Post Jobs" → sees 4 pricing tiers with no context	Clicks "For Employers" → sees the case for annual plans (cost math, discount stack, credibility) before pricing
Comparison	Has to manually calculate per-posting cost, no comparison to competitors implied	Sees an explicit "1 job vs. annual plan" cost table; sees career fair bundle savings quantified in dollars
Decision	Buys either a one-off credit or a plan, career fair treated as separate purchase	Every plan purchase reinforces "you also get X% off your next career fair table" at the moment of decision
Activation	Employer portal, no cross-sell touch	Confirmation/receipt email cross-sells the career fair calendar; dashboard nudges

Stage	Current Experience	Target Experience
		toward the next tier before credits run low
Renewal/Expansion	No visible upsell path back to fairs or higher tiers	Automated "you're on Bronze, you used all 5 slots this month 3 months running — Silver saves you \$X" logic; fair season email drips to plan holders

3. Site Plan (Priority Order)

Priority 1 — Homepage rewrite (the gate)

This is correctly identified as the priority; almost everything downstream depends on it because it's the first-touch page for both audiences and currently serves neither well.

Structure recommendation:

1. **Hero:** Split value prop, employer-first. Lead line should speak to hiring pain ("Fill charter school roles faster, for less than a single job board posting") with a strong secondary CTA for candidates — not the reverse of today's hierarchy.
2. **Immediate proof:** Move a curated, logo-based version of the customer wall (top 15–20 recognizable CMOs/networks — Success Academy, Uncommon Schools, KIPP, Achievement First, etc.) directly under the hero, with a "and 500+ more schools" link to the full list.
3. **Dual-path navigation card:** "I'm Hiring" / "I'm Looking for a Job" — two large tappable cards, not competing nav links.
4. **The annual plan hook, teased, not sold:** One sentence + one number ("Schools on annual plans pay as little as \$1.66 per posting — see plans") linking to the For Employers page, not straight to pricing. Don't sell the SKU on the homepage; sell the idea, then hand off.
5. **Career fair teaser:** Next event date/name with a one-line "plan holders save up to 20% on tables."
6. **Footer trust bar:** "20+ years. 7,500+ educators placed. 500+ schools served." — pull this stat forward from the buried event page.

Priority 2 — New "For Employers" landing page

Currently "Post Jobs" nav item routes straight into pricing (Annual Posting Plans). That's too fast — you're asking for the sale before making the case. Insert a page between nav and pricing:

- Pain/promise headline (recruiting cost + speed)
- The cost-comparison table (see Section 5 below) — this is the single highest-leverage addition you can make
- Career fair + posting plan bundle explainer (the connective tissue piece)
- Condensed logo wall / CMO testimonial
- CTA to Annual Plans page (pricing) AND a secondary CTA to "See upcoming career fairs"

Priority 3 — Annual Posting Plans page (light rework, not rebuild)

- Add the discount **in dollars, not just percent**, directly inside each pricing card (e.g., "Save ~\$X on your next career fair table"). Percent-off is abstract; a school with a budget line item thinks in dollars.
- Add a one-line "vs. buying individually, you save \$X/year" comparison per tier, computed against the à la carte credit price.
- Add plan-holder testimonial or logo directly on this page (currently zero social proof on the actual purchase page — this is a checkout-adjacent trust gap).

Priority 4 — Career fair event pages (e.g., nyc-fair)

This page's "For Schools" section is strong — extend it, don't rebuild it:

- Add one card to the "For Schools" grid: **"Plan Holder Savings"** — explicitly states the 5–20% discount tiers and links to Annual Plans.
- On the registration/cart step, if the employer isn't a plan holder, surface a one-line upsell: "Save up to 20% on this table — see if an annual plan pays for itself."

Priority 5 — Post-purchase & lifecycle touchpoints (not a page, but a flow)

- Purchase confirmation emails for both one-off credits and career fair tables should cross-sell the other product.
 - Dashboard/portal nudge for plan holders approaching their credit limit, before they lapse into buying individual credits at full price.
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4. The Connective Tissue: Career Fairs ⇌ Posting Plans

You asked specifically how to weave these two revenue lines together. Treat the **career fair discount** as the literal bridge — it's already contractually true (it's in the plan terms), it's just invisible. Concrete integration points:

Fair marketing → Plans:

- Every fair email/LinkedIn/Meta campaign to employers should carry a P.S. or closing card: *"Already have a plan? Your table is already discounted up to 20%. Don't have one yet? [See plans and start saving]."*
- Postcard/direct mail to CMO network contacts: add a small callout box quantifying the bundle savings for a school attending 2+ fairs/year.
- Fair landing pages: the "For Schools" grid gets the new "Plan Holder Savings" card (Priority 4 above).

Plans marketing → Fairs:

- Annual Plans page and homepage teaser both reference the *next specific fair by name and date*, not just "career fairs" abstractly — specificity converts better than a category reference.
- Plan purchase confirmation email includes the upcoming fair calendar with one-click "reserve your discounted table" links.
- Consider a **combined "Growth Bundle"** SKU or promo: annual plan + pre-paid fair table at the bundled discount, sold as a single line item at checkout. This turns an implicit benefit into an explicit product, which sells better than a footnote.

Messaging frame to use everywhere: *"One relationship, two ways to hire."* Annual plans handle always-on posting; fairs handle concentrated, high-volume hiring pushes. Position them as complementary tools in the same recruiting budget, not separate purchases — because for a CMO managing a network, that's literally true.

5. The Cost-Comparison Table (build this — it doesn't exist anywhere on the site)

This single asset should appear on the For Employers page and the Annual Plans page. Example structure once your individual credit price is confirmed (the live "Buy Posting Credits" page renders pricing via JS, so pull the current 30-day/60-day rate before publishing):

	Buy Individually	Bronze (\$800/yr)	Silver (\$1,500/yr)	Gold (\$2,500/yr)	Platinum (\$4,000/yr)
Cost per posting	[current à la carte rate]	\$13.31	\$8.32	\$4.16	\$1.66
Postings/year included	—	60	180	600	2,400
Career fair discount	0%	5%	10%	15%	20%
Best for	One-off single hire	Start-up schools	Growing schools	Emerging networks	Large networks

Frame this as "find your plan" rather than a bare price list — ask (or let the visitor self-select) how many roles they typically hire per year, and point them at the tier that pays for itself.

6. Annual Integrated Marketing Calendar

Charter school hiring is seasonal — budget cycles typically finalize in spring, and the heaviest hiring push runs February through August for the following school year. The calendar below aligns posting-plan and fair messaging to that cycle rather than running them as parallel, disconnected tracks.

Period	Primary Push	Plan ⇄ Fair Integration
Sep–Oct (post-hiring-season lull)	Retention/renewal: re-engage schools who bought individually last cycle	"You spent \$X on one-off postings last year — here's what a plan would've saved you" (use their actual purchase history if available)
Nov–Dec (budget planning season)	Annual plan push: schools are setting next year's HR budget now	Position annual plans as a budget line item with predictable cost; tease Q1/Q2 fair calendar so it's part of the same budget conversation

Period	Primary Push	Plan ⇌ Fair Integration
Jan–Feb (early hiring ramp)	Career fair marketing ramps (Meta, LinkedIn, email) for spring fairs	Every fair campaign carries the plan-holder discount message; non-plan-holder fair registrants get a post-registration plan offer
Mar–May (peak hiring season)	Heaviest posting-plan conversion push — this is when unplanned/individual credit buyers feel the most pain	Retarget individual-credit buyers from this window with "you're 3 postings in — a plan would already have paid for itself"
Jun–Aug (late hiring, next-year prep)	Final fair of the cycle + start prepping schools for next year's budget ask	Case-study/testimonial content featuring schools that bundled plan + fair, published ahead of the Sep–Oct renewal push

This closes the loop: renewal messaging in fall references real spend data, budget-season messaging sells the plan as fiscally responsible, hiring-season messaging sells the fair, and peak-season overspend becomes next fall's renewal pitch.

7. Suggested KPIs to Track Post-Launch

- Homepage → For Employers page click-through rate (currently unmeasurable since no dedicated employer page exists)
 - % of career fair table purchases made by existing plan holders vs. new/individual buyers
 - % of plan purchases that reference a fair in the same session/journey (GA4 path analysis)
 - Average individual-credit spend per school before plan conversion (identifies your best upsell trigger point)
 - Plan tier upgrade rate at renewal
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Immediate Next Steps

1. Pull the live à la carte posting credit price (renders via JS on Buy Posting Credits) to finalize the cost-comparison table.

2. Rewrite homepage per Section 3, Priority 1.
3. Build the For Employers page as a new template — this is the missing link between "Post Jobs" nav and the pricing page.
4. Add the "Plan Holder Savings" card to the nyc-fair template so it propagates to future fair pages built from the same Razor template.